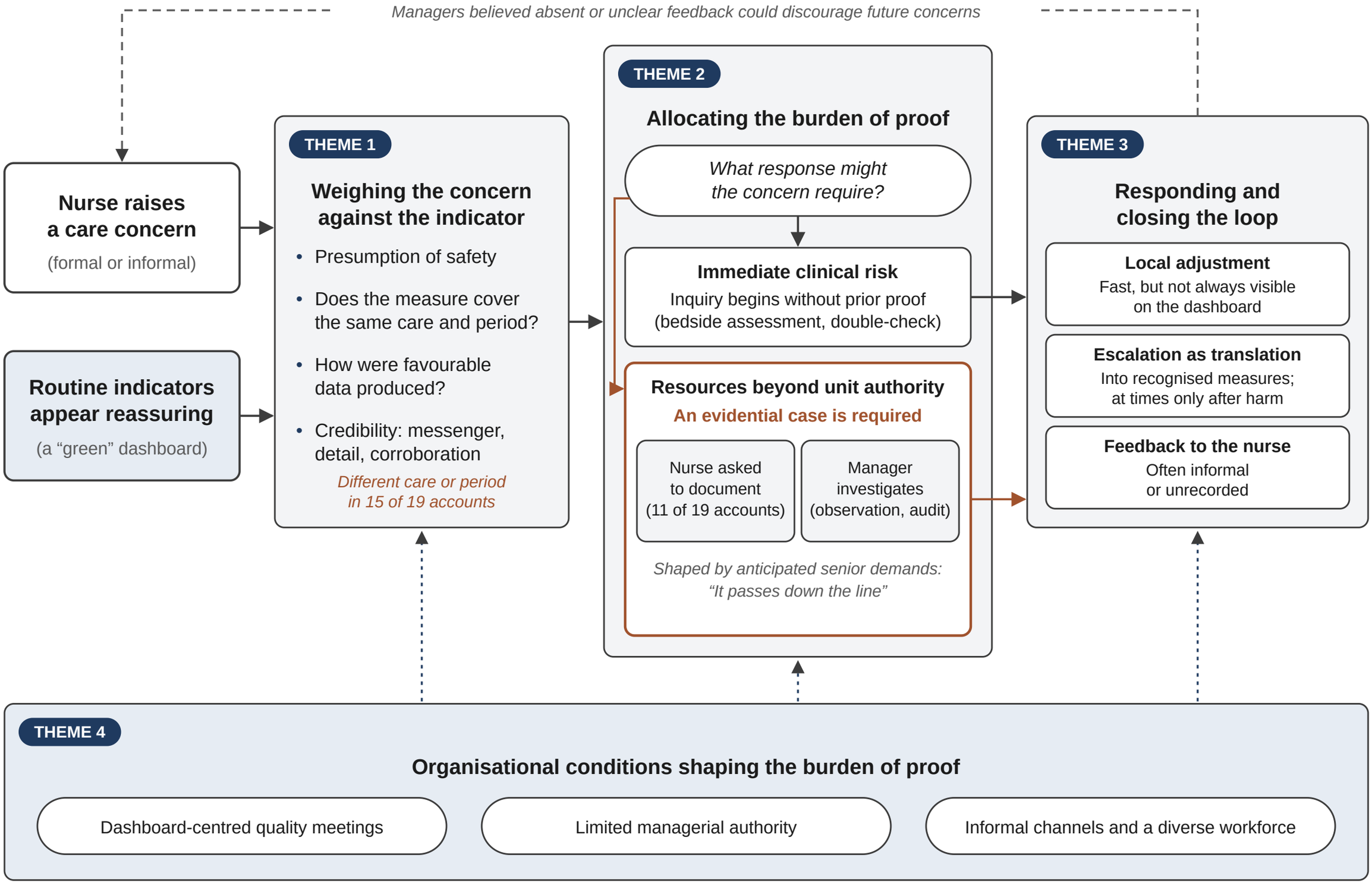
Managers believed absent or unclear feedback could discourage future concerns
Nurse raises a care concern
(formal or informal)
Routine indicators appear reassuring
(a "green" dashboard)
THEME 1
Weighing the concern against the indicator
Presumption of safety
Does the measure cover the same care and period?
How were favourable data produced?
Credibility: messenger, detail, corroboration
Different care or period in 15 of 19 accounts
THEME 2
Allocating the burden of proof
What response might the concern require?
Immediate clinical risk
Inquiry begins without prior proof (bedside assessment, double-check)
Resources beyond unit authority
An evidential case is required
Nurse asked to document (11 of 19 accounts)
Manager investigates (observation, audit)
Shaped by anticipated senior demands: "It passes down the line"
THEME 3
Responding and closing the loop
Local adjustment
Fast, but not always visible on the dashboard
Escalation as translation
Into recognised measures; at times only after harm
Feedback to the nurse
Often informal or unrecorded
THEME 4
Organisational conditions shaping the burden of proof
Dashboard-centred quality meetings
Limited managerial authority
Informal channels and a diverse workforce